

ANNEX — EVIDENCE, SOURCES AND METHOD

This annex is the working record behind the 21 August edition and is published with it every day. The edition carries the judgment, the score and the analysis; this document carries the evidence those rest on — the full commentary column of every live-tape table, the complete strait-operational record with every provider and every denominator named, the macro, energy and freight record in full, the tiered source log and the register of what was rejected or withdrawn, the update protocol, the methodology, and the pre-war anchor with the live trigger levels. **Nothing here is a summary. Where the edition compresses a figure, the uncompressed version is here, and the edition cites this annex by section rather than dropping the material.** Section numbering tracks the edition: A1 corresponds to the edition's section 1, A2.3 to its 2.3, and A7 to A10 are the sections the edition no longer prints.

A1 · Live tape — the full commentary column

Oil and natural gas — Bloomberg front-month / active

21 Aug 2026 readings are intraday prints from the Singapore Friday morning. The last confirmed close, and the scoring reference throughout, is **20 August**. d/d is the 20 Aug close against the 19 Aug close. w/w for the confirmed close runs against **13 Aug**, five sheet-rows back; the intraday row's own five-row base is **14 Aug**, and the two are labelled separately (\$9.20). vs-pre-war is against the 27 Feb 2026 close, re-verified field by field and unchanged. **The \$9.8 row check CLEARS decisively** — every populated field of the 20 Aug row differs from the snapshot published for it. **The field-level check under \$9.35 RAISES ONE FLAG**, and it is the 30-year again: see the UST table. Two roll and restatement events affect the WTI complex this edition and are disclosed in 2.1 rather than absorbed silently.

Benchmark	Latest reading (basis in row)	Δ d/d (20 Aug close vs 19 Aug)	Δ vs pre-war close (27 Feb)	BBG ticker
Brent · 20 Aug close (last confirmed — the scoring reference)	\$91.97 /bbl	+\$2.18 vs the 19 Aug close \$89.79 (+\$6.75 w/w vs 13 Aug)	from \$72.48 (+26.9%) — a \$19.49/bbl premium . The highest Brent close since 24 July and a FIFTH consecutive up-close (14, 17, 18, 19 and 20 Aug), which equals the five-close runs ending 23 July and 12 August; the war's longest is eight, ending 29 April. It leaves the channel \$3.03 below the \$95 upgrade trigger and \$19.49 above the \$72.48 downgrade anchor . The upgrade gap has now narrowed in four consecutive editions — 9.78, 8.43, 5.55, 5.21, 3.03 , which is four narrowings across five readings. Still \$26.38 below the 31 Mar war high of \$118.35	CO2 Comdty (Close)
Brent front-month · 21 Aug intraday	\$91.51 /bbl (H 91.90 / L 91.28)	−\$0.46 vs the 20 Aug close (+\$4.94 w/w vs 14 Aug)	The Friday morning gives back a fifth of Thursday's gain in a 62-cent range. Active COA prints \$93.32 , which is \$1.68 from the \$95 upgrade trigger ; the 20 Aug active CLOSE of \$93.78 is \$1.22 away and the highest active close since 23 July . An intraday print cannot move this channel (\$4a) and no part of the score below uses one	CO2 / COA Comdty
RECONCILIATION — the 20 August snapshot UNDERSTATED every reconciled field bar one, and in one direction	Brent closed \$91.97 vs \$90.05 carried	gap +\$1.92	The mirror image of last edition, and near-one-directional in the way \$9.31 was written for — every reconciled field bar Henry Hub settled the same way. Every reconciled field bar one settled ABOVE the Singapore print: Brent +\$1.92 , COA +\$1.81, TTF +€0.895, DXY +0.065, and across the curve +2.75 bp on the 2-year, +5.49 on the 5-year, +6.74 on the 10-year and +6.38 on the 30-year , with 2s10s +3.776, BE10 +4.52 and 5Y5Y +2.42. No field is excluded this edition: all four tenors printed live values differing from the prior close, so \$9.37 does not bite. THE ONE EXCEPTION IS HENRY HUB, which settled \$0.051 BELOW its snapshot; it is named rather than dropped. WTI is not reconciled because this edition's roll and restatement break it, and Asia LNG, MOVE and VIX had no 20 Aug snapshot to measure against. The 30-year gap of 6.38 bp is the third-largest long-end reconciliation on record behind 9.68 bp (19 Aug) and 7.59 bp (31 Jul). Running Brent gap series: +\$0.72, +\$0.87, −\$0.13, +\$1.29, +\$2.60, −\$0.45, +\$1.92 . Cause: the US macro releases and the 30-year TIPS auction all landed after the Singapore cut (\$9.1). WITHDRAWN AS TRENDS, NOT AS FACTS ABOUT 19 AUGUST (\$9.20, \$9.31): (a) B's lapse was real on the 19 Aug close and is counted as one of the nine states — but it re-armed on the very next close, so the LAPSE-WILL-HOLD reading is withdrawn; (b) the legs 'converged' at 19.11 bp on 19 Aug and the CONVERGENCE reading is withdrawn — the 30-year leg widened straight back out from 19.11 bp to 24.76; (c) the dollar's 'lowest close since 14 May' stands as a fact about 19 August but is withdrawn as a trend, the 20 Aug close having taken six hundredths of it back. The 19 August closes themselves are unrestated and every superlative published about them holds	CO2 Comdty / derived

Benchmark	Latest reading (basis in row)	Δ d/d (20 Aug close vs 19 Aug)	Δ vs pre-war close (27 Feb)	BBG ticker
WTI front-month — ROLL EVENT, and the apparent d/d is an artifact	\$84.37 /bbl (CL2)	20 Aug close \$86.83 , +\$2.44 (+\$6.39 w/w vs 13 Aug)	from \$67.02 (+29.6%) on the 20 Aug close. The scored CL2 continuation and the CLA active contract printed identical to the cent on EVERY session from 3 to 20 August and diverge by \$1.93 today. That is a contract roll, and the apparent −\$2.46 move from Thursday's close to Friday's CL2 print is a roll artifact, not a price move : on the active contract the fall is 53 cents , to \$86.30. \$9.36 applies and this is its first live occurrence. Separately, the CLA column has been RESTATED across the whole 3–20 August window — the 19 August active close this monitor published as \$85.83 now reads \$84.39 (\$3)	CL2 / CLA Comdty
Brent–WTI spread	\$5.14 /bbl front on the 20 Aug close	\$6.95 on the active contracts , from \$7.23 on 19 Aug	Both legs are affected by this edition's roll and restatement and neither is offered as a clean series. On the restated active basis the war high is \$7.23, set on 19 August , so Thursday's \$6.95 is a narrowing from a record set one session earlier and is NOT itself a record . The front-month spread of \$5.14 is not comparable with Friday's \$7.14, which spans the roll. Reported as a watch item; no directional finding is claimed from it this edition	derived
Henry Hub natural gas	\$2.760 /MMBtu (21 Aug intraday)	20 Aug close \$2.733 , −\$0.081 (+\$0.006 w/w)	from \$3.063 (−10.8%). US gas is the control variable in this document. It closed 10.8% BELOW its pre-war level on the same session that European gas closed 109.1% ABOVE its own — and that TTF/Henry Hub pair is the load-bearing comparison, because both are exchange-settled and both are in this extract. Asian LNG at +112.3% points the same way but is single-sourced and is cited as corroboration, not as evidence. A global energy shock does not produce that dispersion; a chokepoint routing dislocation does	NGA Comdty (Close)
TTF Dutch gas (active) — NEW WAR RECORD CLOSE	€64.855 /MWh (21 Aug intraday)	20 Aug close €65.295 , +€1.914 (+€4.895 w/w)	from €31.227 (+109.1%). This is the first CLOSE above the €63.649 record set on 24 July, and the first close above €65 of the war. Two consecutive editions reported an intraday print above the record and declined to call it one; the close has now done it. The Friday intraday of €64.855 is below the new record and is not a second one. Named drivers could NOT be sourced for the 19–20 August move specifically ; the standing structural drivers are Norwegian pipeline outages, with total exit nominations reported down near 50% from the early-August peak and the Ormen Lange outage extended to February 2027, plus Asian competition for cargoes	TZTA Comdty (Close)
Japan/Asia LNG (20 Aug close — no 21 Aug print)	¥3,543	+¥16 vs the 19 Aug close ¥3,527 (+¥176 w/w)	from ¥1,669 (+112.3%) — the highest close since 24 July (¥3,593) and a fifth consecutive rising print. No 21 Aug print; flagged and NOT carried as a reading (\$9.2). The level could not be corroborated outside the terminal and is single-sourced. Hormuz normally moves roughly a fifth of global LNG (standing reference, unsourced this edition).	JGLA Comdty (Close)

US Treasuries and inflation expectations — Bloomberg

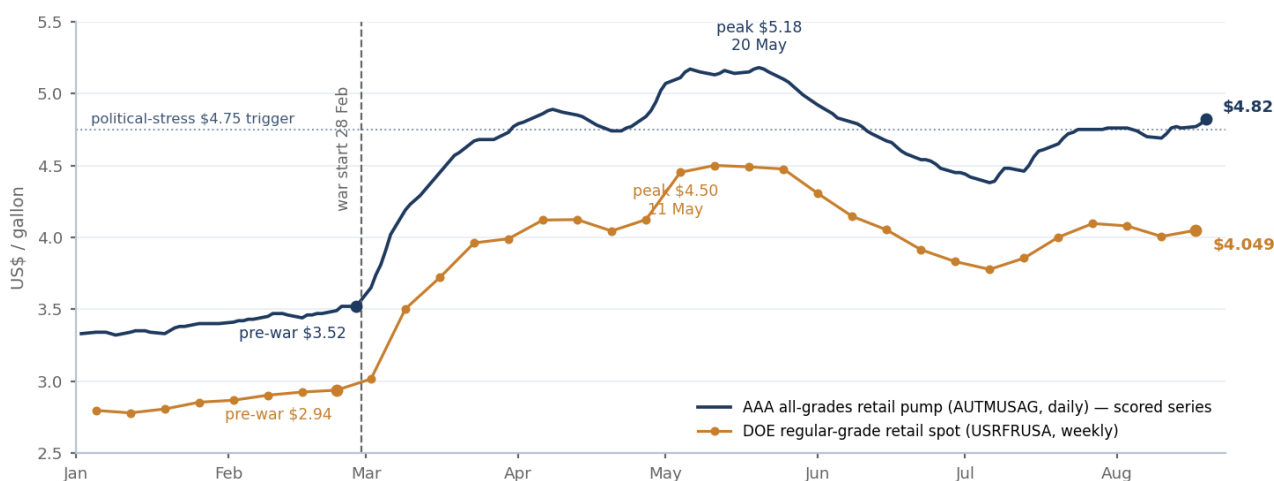
§9.35 FIRES, AND ON THE 30-YEAR FOR THE SECOND TIME. The 21 August row prints the 30-year at **5.2476%**, identical to four decimal places to the **20 August close**, in a row where the 2-, 5- and 10-year and the 2s10s spread all moved. **Under the corrected rule that field is UNRESOLVED and NO day-on-day change is asserted for it** — which is precisely the configuration that concealed a war high on 17 August and forced the rule to be rewritten. Every other TENOR on the row is a live print; MOVE, VIX and SOFR have no 21 August print at all and are not carried. Triggers and Stage-4 tests run on the **20 Aug close**. No UST row in the last three was restated on any field and no yield series backfilled. Two changes fall OUTSIDE the curve and are disclosed in 1 and 2.1: the WTI active column was restated across 3–20 August, and AUTMUSAG backfilled for 19 August. No other series changed.

Tenor / measure	20 Aug close	Δ d/d	Δ w/w (vs 13 Aug)	Reading	21 Aug intraday
2-year	4.1875%	+2.52 bp	+4.51 bp	The short end participated this time, unlike Wednesday. A strong data day moves the front end; a buyback announcement does not. +81.26 bp vs pre-war	4.1811%
5-year	4.3904%	+4.78 bp	+7.40 bp	The largest w/w rise on the curve. +88.87 bp vs pre-war	4.3833%
10-year	4.7041%	+5.75 bp	+6.14 bp	Back above 4.65% and above the 4.70% handle, and the leg that re-armed Threshold B. It has now closed above 4.70% on three of the last five sessions. +76.66 bp vs pre-war	4.7001%
30-year	5.2476%	+5.65 bp	+3.51 bp	Gives back 62% of Wednesday's 9.15 bp fall in one session, and is the largest one-day rise in the tenor since 31 July. It leaves the 30-year 5.84 bp below Monday's war high of 5.3060%, 3.16 bp ABOVE the 13 August auction stop of 5.216% — having closed 2.49 bp below it a session earlier — and 19.76 bp above the 13 May stop. Still +63.70 bp vs pre-war	UNRESOLVED (§9.35)
2s10s (separate ticker; does not tie exactly to its legs)	51.235 bp	+3.226 bp	+1.414 bp	A bear steepener that reverses Wednesday's bull flattener by roughly two thirds. 4.41 bp flatter than pre-war	51.683 bp
10-year breakeven	2.3525%	+4.47 bp	+9.35 bp	The highest close since 8 June and 9.56 bp above the 2.2569% pre-war anchor. On 13 August this series sat 0.21 bp above that anchor and this document reported it as within a single basis point of going below pre-war for the first time in the war. It is now nine and a half basis points the other way in five sessions. Inflation compensation is rebuilding faster than nominal yields are	2.3529%
5y5y forward	2.3432%	+3.26 bp	+5.32 bp	A FIFTH consecutive close above the 2.30% level whose sustained break fired this channel 4→5 on 31 July, now by 4.32 bp — the widest clearance since 12 August. The documented downgrade at the 2.142% anchor is 20.12 bp away, WIDENED from 16.86 (§9.16, §9.26)	2.3415%
MOVE (rate volatility)	73.18	+1.92	+3.95	Still below 75, for a third consecutive close (74.98, 71.26, 73.18) — which equals the 12–14 August run as the longest of the current regime and is far short of the 21-session run of 10 Jun–10 Jul (§9.32). It is 0.20 below the 73.38 pre-war anchor, so the anchor comparison is now marginal rather than clear	no print
VIX	16.01	+1.12	+1.38	The highest close since 4 August, and 1.76 above the 14.25 series low of 14 August. Still 3.85 below the 19.86 pre-war level	no print
SOFR	no 20 Aug print	—	—	Blank on both 20 and 21 August, a second dark session. The last print is 3.62 on 19 August. Not carried (§9.9)	no print

Cross-asset stress and political-transmission gauges — Bloomberg and Tier 1 primary sources

Gauge	20 Aug close	Δ d/d	vs pre-war	What it says
DXY dollar index	98.895	+0.062	97.608 (+1.3%)	The three-month low lasted exactly one close. Wednesday's 98.833 was the lowest since 14 May and the fourth-largest one-day fall of the war; Thursday took six hundredths of it back and the 21 Aug intraday sits at 98.814, which is THROUGH Wednesday's low — but an intraday print cannot move this channel or set a record (\$4a), and only a close can. The claim withdrawn here is not the number but the trend read off it — a currency that falls 0.824 on a supply-side announcement and does not extend has repriced a level, not a regime. The dollar is still 1.3% ABOVE its pre-war level after six months of war
MOVE / VIX	73.18 / 16.01	+1.92 / +1.12	73.38 / 19.86	Both rose and MOVE is now only 0.20 below its pre-war anchor , against 2.12 below a session earlier. Threshold C sits 56.82 points away ; the war high is 115.02 (26 March) and the series low 65.39 (18 June), so this is not the furthest from C the war has been (\$9.32). The pairing still stands: rate volatility at its pre-war level while the 30-year sits 63.70 bp above its own
AAA all-grades retail pump (scored)	\$4.82 (19 Aug)	+3c vs 18 Aug	\$3.52 (+36.9%)	BACKFILLED — a new print the last edition did not have, and the highest since 5 June (\$4.83). It is 7 cents above the \$4.75 trigger that fired this channel to 5 on 4 August, and the named \$4.60 downgrade condition is now 22 cents away, WIDENED from 19. No print for 20 or 21 August — two dark sessions, exactly as a fortnight ago (\$9.30). The series has risen on six of its last nine prints and fallen on three
AAA national averages (Tier 1, gasprices.aaa.com, read directly)	regular \$4.1044 · diesel \$5.5477	+1.84c / +4.35c	n/a	AAA diesel made a second consecutive war high on 20 August and is now 26.82 cents below its all-time record of \$5.8159 (19 June 2022). Diesel is up 14.34 cents on the week and 43.98 on the month against regular's 3.29 and 10.12. AAA's own headline: 'High Crude Oil Prices Push Up National Average'. Do not merge this with the scored AUTMUSAG series — different grades, different construction. No 21 August publication at the time of writing
DOE weekly retail regular (corroboration)	\$4.049 (week of 17 Aug)	unchanged this edition	~\$2.94	The survey publishes Tuesdays and the next print is 25 August ; the on-highway diesel average is \$5.454. The values could not be re-verified outside the terminal for a second consecutive edition and are carried with that flag. EIA no longer publishes 'This Week in Petroleum'
US front-month diesel crack	no published print for 19, 20 or 21 Aug	—	~\$42.01 (27 Feb)	No new record and no new print. The all-time high stands at \$102.20 intraday on 17 August and a triple-digit settle on 18 August , the first in history, per Bloomberg and corroborated by Reuters. The derived ~\$101.2 figure this monitor computed for 19 August is NOT repeated as an observation ; no outlet has published a crack for any of the last three sessions. Distillate stocks remain 105.6 mn bbl, 13% below the five-year average , on the 14 August EIA week. Two unresolved source conflicts persist: the pre-2026 record is \$89 (Bloomberg) or \$86.82 (DTN), and — as a standing item, since this edition makes no lowest-since stocks claim — the distillate comparison is 'since 1996' or 'since 1998'

US retail gasoline — the two tracked series, 2026 year-to-date



AUTMUSAG (AAA all-grades retail pump, daily) is the political-stress score reference (pre-war \$3.52, peak \$5.18, latest print **\$4.82 on 19 Aug, backfilled this edition**; 20 and 21 Aug blank); USRFRUSA (DOE regular-grade retail spot, weekly) is nominally the corroborating series — though it has not been re-verifiable outside the terminal for two editions and is not currently corroborating anything (pre-war ~\$2.94, peak \$4.50, latest **\$4.049 for the week of 17 Aug**). The dotted line is the \$4.75 political→5 threshold. **The navy line has now closed above the trigger on six consecutive prints and is at its highest since 5 June.** The six-session decline that began at \$4.75 on 4 August and ended at \$4.69 on 10 August has been fully round-tripped: the series is thirteen cents above that low and seven cents above the level the decline started from. **The divergence that matters is inside the barrel, not between the two series:** AAA retail diesel rose 14.34 cents on the week against regular's 3.29, which is what a distillate shortage looks like by the time it reaches a forecourt.

Strait operational state

Item	State as at 21 Aug 2026	Source / tier
UKMTO / JMIC advisory — UPDATE 087 PUBLISHED; THE FROZEN COUNT BREAKS	Update 087, dated 20 August (ICOD 201500Z), retrieved in full. Cumulative confirmed vessel incidents move from 91 to 94 on three new incidents since the last report. The threat matrix is unchanged across all nine regions: Hormuz SEVERE, Gulf of Oman / Gulf of Aden / Bab el-Mandeb SUBSTANTIAL, Arabian Gulf, Arabian Sea, Somali Coast and North Red Sea MODERATE, East Med LOW. The material change is in the prose, not the matrix. Where 086 said attack frequency 'has increased over the reporting period', 087 says it 'has remained consistent over the reporting period... and the environment reflects an established post-MoU status quo'; VHF hailing goes from 'reduced reports' to 'occasional'. CORRECTION TO THIS MONITOR'S RECORD: Update 086 is dated 18 August, not 17; the 17 August date attaches to the blockade tally inside it, not to the product. No Update 088 and no VRA Overview No.3 could be retrieved — No.2 of 14 August remains current; 087 was obtained by direct file URL because the UKMTO indexes render empty to an anonymous fetch, so both negatives are inconclusive rather than proven. Update 081 unretrievable for a seventh edition	UKMTO/JMIC Update 087, read in full 21 Aug (Tier 1 primary)
The three new incidents — 116-26, 117-26, 118-26	116-26 (logged 18 Aug) — ATTACK, STRAIT OF HORMUZ. A bulk carrier, name withheld; OSINT reported a vessel attacked on 15 August, and a nearby vessel relayed VHF contact with the Master, who stated that a rocket hit the starboard side under the gangway, with one confirmed crew fatality. Vessel not under command; no environmental damage. 117-26 (18 Aug) — ATTACK, BAB EL-MANDEB. Six anti-ship ballistic missiles were fired at an anchored vessel in Yemeni territorial waters and five struck, causing complete structural destruction; no crew and no cargo were aboard. 118-26 (20 Aug) — HIJACK, GULF OF ADEN, the tanker SEAMULL (a.k.a. SIBU 1), Eritrea-flagged, 34NM off Yemen in the eastern IRTC; upgraded from attack to hijack at 0957Z with about six armed persons aboard stating an intent to proceed to Bosaso, Somalia. 118-26 is Somali-basin piracy and is segregated from the Hormuz count. UNRESOLVED AND REPORTED, NOT SMOOTHED: 115-26 (in 086) and 116-26 (in 087) are logged as two separate fatal attacks — 115-26 an engine-room strike 0.5NM off Oman, 116-26 a rocket to the starboard side dated 15 August. Open-source reporting of the MINOAN DIGNITY shares elements with both. The incident numbering says two; they are not merged here	UKMTO 087 (Tier 1 primary) / INTERCARGO via Maritime Executive (Tier 2)
Hormuz transit counts — each provider on its own denominator, never averaged (\$9.24)	UKMTO annex (S&P/SeaVision), the only primary series, now extends to 19 August: Hormuz cargo transits 0 (17 Aug), 1 (18 Aug), 0 (19 Aug); tankers 3 / 3 / 3 — a combined 3, 4 and 3 transits a day against the ~138/day 2025 baseline this annex is built on, which counts ALL transits, cargo and tanker together. US NCAGS-facilitated 42 over the 18–19 Aug 48 hours — a facilitated subset, never added to the others. Kpler via Al Jazeera (20 Aug), a PERIOD total and not a daily: 236 transits of all types across 1–19 August — 83 openly Iranian route, 3 openly Omani, 2 old central route, and 148 dark or unknown (62.7%); for oil and gas alone, 112 vessels of which 21 Iranian, 2 Omani and 89 dark (79.5%); Kpler's own summary rounds this to 'above 80%' and the arithmetic is printed here instead). Kpler's Mohamed Rafik Halitim: the dark share makes it 'highly difficult to determine what proportion may also have used the Omani route'. That is the provider, for the second consecutive edition, declining to make the claim the wire made for it. Windward (19 Aug): 16 contacts in 24 hours, 10 in / 6 out, of which 9 ran dark including 5 imagery-only with no AIS and no IMO — 'dark contacts now outnumber AIS-visible ones for the first time'. Lloyd's List (19 Aug, weekly): 73 transits for 10–16 August, preliminary and expected to revise UP, from 91 the prior week; cargo-carrying vessels above 10,000 dwt only. IMF PortWatch still 1 for 16 August against its own ~73/day. Nothing at all from TankerMap, LSEG or NCAGS for 20–21 August. HARD CAVEAT ON EVERY AIS-DERIVED FIGURE: Windward recorded 497 GPS-jammed vessels in the Persian Gulf on 19 August — 7.1% of 7,033 transmitting — and 1,418 false ship-to-ship meetings in one day, with blockade-breaker identity mismatches spiking to 24 of 74 matched vessels against a usual 1–2. Three different pre-war baselines are now in circulation — ~138/day (UKMTO annex, all transits), ~130/day (Al Jazeera) and ~73/day (IMF PortWatch on its own chokepoint series) — and no percentage of normal is quoted here without naming which	UKMTO 087 annex (Tier 1) / Kpler via Al Jazeera, 20 Aug (Tier 1) / Windward and Lloyd's List, 19 Aug (Tier 1 provider) / IMF PortWatch (Tier 2)
Throughput — the Axios convoy claim now has a tracker sitting against it	Axios (19 Aug, two unnamed US officials): a nightly US-escorted corridor along the southern Omani channel, 15–20 tankers each night, close to 10 mn b/d out of the strait, 'roughly half pre-war', run by a task force out of Fort Bragg. 'Roughly half' implies a ~20 mn b/d baseline; this document uses ~15 mb/d, on which 10 would be about two thirds. The denominators do not agree and are not reconciled. It was picked up by seven outlets on 20 August and every one traces to Axios; there is no independent Tier 1 verification, no DoD confirmation and no denial. The tension to report — and not to reconcile — is that Windward logged 16 total strait contacts in both directions across all cargo types on 19 August, which is not obviously compatible with 15–20 tankers a night through one corridor unless nearly all of the convoy traffic is undetected. Against both: Kpler puts crude clearance across the 60-day MoU window at 6.1 mb/d, about 40% of the ~15 mb/d Hormuz averaged in 2025, and warns that its own most recent week revises up by a factor of 1.5 to 2.0 — which is now a sourceable basis for this monitor's rule against computing a day-on-day off a same-day Kpler print. Energy Secretary Wright's ~15 mn b/d has no update	Axios, 19 Aug (Tier 1, unnamed) / Windward and Kpler, 19 Aug (Tier 1 provider)
US naval blockade — the tally moves	65 commercial vessels redirected, three disabled and two boarded as of 19 August, attributed to US CENTCOM and reproduced verbatim in UKMTO Update 087 §2C — up from 64 as of 17 August. CENTCOM is therefore publishing enforcement numbers through a channel other than its own public-releases index. The '91 redirected' caption on CENTCOM's media page still conflicts with its own statement and is still NOT used. The Washington Post report of 18 August that DoD is assessing a smaller Gulf footprint has produced no confirmation, denial or follow-through dated 20 or 21 August, and no statement from Defense Secretary Hegseth could be sourced in the window; the standing formulation remains his 13 August 'indefinitely'	CENTCOM via UKMTO 087 §2C (Tier 1) / WaPo, 18 Aug (Tier 1 outlet, unnamed sourcing)

Item	State as at 21 Aug 2026	Source / tier
CENTCOM combat activity — 23 days, and the one thing it did announce	The public-releases index was read directly. The most recent release describing a strike inside Iran is still 29 July — now a 23-day gap — and the most recent release of any kind is 15 August, on the commander's regional trip. There is no release dated 20 or 21 August. CENTCOM did nonetheless announce on 20 August that the USS George Washington has ARRIVED IN THEATRE to relieve the USS Abraham Lincoln after 250-plus days — but the strike group is still transiting the Arabian Sea toward the Gulf of Oman, so the relief is UNDER WAY and not complete; the announcement came through press rather than the releases index, and is reported here as Tier 2 attributed to a CENTCOM statement. Nothing at all on USS George H.W. Bush. Note that the NEWS-ARTICLES index is stale to February 2026 and is not a usable channel — the PUBLIC-RELEASES index is the primary source and must be the one queried	centcom.mil public releases, read 21 Aug (Tier 1 primary) / Washington Examiner citing CENTCOM, 20 Aug (Tier 2)
Oman — the mediator published on Hormuz for the first time in twelve days	Both fm.gov.om indexes were read directly and the exact queries are recorded (\$9.23). Most recent item of ANY kind: 20 August , three items. Most recent Iran/Hormuz news item: 20 August — a joint press conference with Japanese Foreign Minister Motegi at which both 'called for intensified international efforts to ensure freedom of navigation through the Strait of Hormuz', with Badr Albusaidi saying 'lasting security in the Strait of Hormuz requires a lasting peace in the region' and Motegi that 'the situation concerning Iran is at a highly critical stage'. The item mentions neither the United States, nor the blockade, nor the bilateral Iran–Oman track. Most recent Hormuz statement: 14 July ; most recent Oman–Iran joint statement: 23 June . The joint declaration has still NOT been issued and Qatar's gate has not opened. Oman has still published nothing on the 14 August attacks in its own territorial waters and nothing on being threatened with US bombardment. Separately, its own index records the Sultan visiting the UAE on 17 August — two days before the UAE announced, on 19 August, that all trade, commercial exchanges and financial transactions with Iran were halted until further notice (UAE MFA, Tier 1)	fm.gov.om, both indexes read 21 Aug (Tier 1 primary)
Red Sea and the wider periphery	Bab el-Mandeb transits ROSE: 71 vessels over the 18–19 August 48 hours, against 59 over 16–17 August — about 35/day against a ~61/day 2023 baseline. Al-Mokha remains completely closed. The one confirmed Red Sea incident in 087, 117-26, destroyed an unmanned, cargo-less hull. The Houthi claim to have struck Aramco's Jazan refinery on 18 August is now in its fourth day with no Saudi or Aramco comment and no Tier 1 corroboration — carried as a CLAIM only , unlike the confirmed 9 August strike. SIX vessels are now under pirate control — HONOUR 25, SWORD, EUREKA, ASANA, LUTUF and, from 20 August, SEAMULL — and every one of them is Somali-basin piracy, kept strictly segregated from the Hormuz count. NO kinetic event anywhere in the Hormuz theatre is dated 20 or 21 August , and a Tier 2 aggregator puts at 21 the run of nights with no US or Israeli strike inside Iran and no acknowledged coalition air operation anywhere in theatre. That count excludes vessel attacks and is a different measure from the UKMTO incident count, which rose by three in the same window. A circulating attribution of an ADNOC-vessel attack to Friday 21 August is REJECTED: the source page is dated 14 August, which was also a Friday	UKMTO 087 (Tier 1) / GlobalSecurity daily update, 20 Aug (Tier 2) / SABA (Tier 3), uncorroborated

A2.3 · The macro session that took the rally back, and the economic war declared over it

Four US releases landed on the morning of 20 August and every one of them came in at or above consensus. The Philadelphia Fed's August manufacturing index printed +47.4, which the Philadelphia Fed reports as a **five-year high**, from 41.4 in July — a very large upside surprise on any of the consensus figures in circulation, which ranged from 6.3 to 25.0, and **the spread of those consensus figures is itself a caveat on how big the 'surprise' was**. Initial jobless claims fell 6,000 to 206,000. Existing home sales came in at 4.05M SAAR against a 3.94M consensus, a second consecutive monthly decline but a beat, with the median price at \$434,100 and a 37th straight month of annual gains. The Conference Board's leading index rose 0.2% and its six-month growth rate turned positive at +0.2% from -1.3%. The long end sold off through all of it, which is the ordinary and expected response and is precisely why it matters here: it means Wednesday's 9 bp rally was not a repricing of risk but a repricing of supply, and one strong data day was enough to take most of it back. A Fed official said the same thing in different words, speaking only for himself. St. Louis's Alberto Musalem told CNBC on 20 August that the bond selloff reflects 'a competition for capital... from government financing... plus the AI build-out' and not a Fed credibility problem; that policy is still 'accommodative' with the real funds rate below neutral; and that underlying inflation is running 2.5–3% against a 2% target. He declined to prejudge September. September pricing sits at roughly a 68% hold on a 20 August reading — but that figure comes through a secondary aggregator citing CME FedWatch, not from CME directly, and no clean dated CME print could be sourced for a second consecutive edition. Jackson Hole runs 27–29 August on 'Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy', with Chair Warsh's first keynote on Friday 28 August — nineteen days before the 16 September FOMC; the Kansas City Fed's own programme still could not be retrieved and the agenda remains Tier 2. GDPNow is unchanged at 4.0% for Q3, dated 18 August, with the next revision on 26 August. On the economic-war track, the rhetoric ran well ahead of the instrument. Trump announced an 'ECONOMIC D-DAY' late on 19 August New York time — after the last edition's Singapore cut — warning that **any** country whose financial institutions, airports, ship registries or exchange houses provide Iran a lifeline will face 'tremendous economic consequences', naming oil smuggling, swap lines, cash transfers, exchange houses, ship registries and front companies. Bessent followed on CNBC on 20 August: 'It is a one-two punch. We have the blockade, and we are going to have the toughest sanctions in history... we are going to collapse this regime', and on third countries 'you're either with us or against us'. He declined to say whether China would be targeted, noting that the Chinese take about half their energy from inside the Gulf. What actually issued on 20 August is not that package. OFAC's action of that date designates ten individuals in a Hizballah cash-smuggling network, three of them tagged as linked to the IRGC-Qods Force, and amends Hizballah's own SDN entry to carry an IRGC-QF designation. There is no Iranian oil, shipping, refinery, bank, ship-registry or vessel designation, no Iran-related executive order and no new general licence; the designees are mostly Turkey-based and two carry UAE addresses, and the only vessels added that day are Ecuadorian fishing boats under the counter-narcotics programme. On the third day after 'Economic D-Day', on this document's inclusive count, the Hormuz-facing sanctions remain undelivered. China's foreign ministry said on 20 August that 'imposing sanctions and pressuring do not help to solve the issue'. On the regional track, Majlis Speaker Ghalibaf's three-day visit to Iraq, which opened in Baghdad on 19 August and takes in Karbala and Najaf, concludes on Friday 21 August; no readout from the Karbala or Najaf legs has been published (The National and Asharq Al-Awsat, 19 Aug, Tier 1/Tier 2). A single-sourced report that he discussed an Iranian plan to conceal militia weapons is confirmed by neither government and is NOT used. Iran's answer came from Araghchi the same morning: the 'so-called Economic D-Day' is 'a diversion from America's own crisis: unprecedented debt and surging interest costs'. Whatever its motive, it names the transmission channel this document tracks, and it is the government the mechanism is aimed at that named it. The characterisation of the debt level as 'unprecedented' is Araghchi's and is not tested here. Elsewhere on the energy and freight record, most of the standing figures did not refresh and are labelled rather than rolled forward. No EIA, IEA, OPEC or OPEC+ release dated 20 or 21 August; the next OPEC+ meeting is 6 September and effective OPEC spare capacity of 0.07 mb/d, a 3Q26 deficit of 1.8 mb/d and 8.3 mb/d shut in all survive unrevised. The Baltic week-34 tanker averages could not be retrieved and are reported as not obtained, NOT as unchanged; week 33 was VLCC \$234,821/day, Suezmax \$269,824/day and Aframax \$77,182/day. Lloyd's List assessed TD3C MEG-China above \$520,000/day on 19 August — a single route, never comparable with the global VLCC average, and Lloyd's List itself has described Middle East VLCC index rates in this crisis as thinly underpinned. War-risk cover still has nothing newer than Marsh's 7.5–10% of hull of 22 July; a '3–8% of vessel value' range circulating as industry estimate has no named broker and is not used, and straits.live's '40x normal' is its own model, not a quote. The covert relay is unchanged rather than deepened: Windward reported on 19 August that two Hong Kong-flagged, Chinese-managed tankers aborted Hormuz transits within 24 hours, one broadcasting 'CHINESE CREW OWNER' in its AIS destination field, and that China's two largest state operators are keeping fleets out of both chokepoints on Beijing's guidance; Kharg saw its first terminal activity in 23 days, a dark vessel at the sulphur and LPG berth — 'a marginal signal... not yet a clear reversal'. Iranian crude loadings remain 156 kb/d through 17 August against 893 kb/d in July, and crude on water in the Mideast Gulf and Gulf of Oman 110 mn bbl on 18 August; neither has a 20 or 21 August update. DP World is spending about \$100m a month keeping Jebel Ali ready to reopen against container throughput at roughly 10% of pre-crisis levels, and ADNOC L&S has disclosed \$1.3bn of VLCC and VLGC purchases — balance-sheet positioning for a long closure.

A7 · Source log

Tier	Source	Used for
Tier 1 · market data	Bloomberg extract 'US Iran BBG Data.xlsx', refreshed 21 Aug 2026	All price, yield, volatility and gasoline series. 169 raw rows × 99 columns ; header row scanned, not hardcoded. Front-month auto-detect resolved CO2/CL2; DXY resolved as 'DXY Index'. The 27 Feb anchor was re-verified field by field and is unchanged. The \$9.8 row-level check CLEARS decisively. The \$9.35 field-level check FIRES once, on the 30-year, which is reported UNRESOLVED with no d/d asserted. The CL2 continuation rolled on the 21 Aug row and the CLA column was restated across 3–20 August; both are disclosed in 1 and 2.1. No series backfilled apart from AUTMUSAG for 19 Aug.
Tier 1 · US official primary	US Treasury Fiscal Data auctions API — releases R_20260819_2 (20-year, CUSIP 912810UX4) and R_20260820_3 (30-year TIPS, CUSIP 912810US5); Philadelphia Fed MBOS, August 2026; DOL initial claims; NAR existing home sales; Conference Board LEI; OFAC recent actions 20 Aug and Treasury release SB0611; EIA WPSR week ending 14 Aug; Atlanta Fed GDPNow (18 Aug)	The full 20-year and 30-year TIPS auction internals, including the allotment splits on both denominators. The 20 Aug macro actuals. The Hizballah/IRGC-QF designations and the absence of any Iranian oil, shipping or registry action. Crude, distillate and SPR levels. Q3 GDP tracking. Note for future editions: the TreasuryDirect PDF endpoints return empty to a fetcher; the Fiscal Data auctions API is the working primary route and should be the standing method.
Tier 1 · maritime and military primary	UKMTO/JMIC Update 087 (ICOD 201500Z) and its annex, read in full; UKMTO VRA Overview No.2 (14 Aug); centcom.mil public-releases index, read 21 Aug; fm.gov.om news and statements indexes, both read 21 Aug	The cumulative count of 94, incidents 116-26, 117-26 and 118-26, all nine threat levels, the changed assessment language, the Hormuz and Bab el-Mandeb transit annex to 19 Aug, the NCAGS 48-hour figure, the six held vessels, and the CENTCOM blockade tally of 65 as of 19 Aug. The 23-day gap since the last combat release inside Iran was verified against the public-releases index, not the news-articles index, which is stale to February 2026. Oman's publication record was queried on four separate questions and each answer is stated with its query (\$9.23).
Tier 1 · news	CNBC and Al Jazeera/Reuters (20 Aug, Bessent); ABC News, Middle East Eye and The Hill (20 Aug, Araghchi); ABC, CNBC and Al Jazeera (19 Aug, Trump); Bloomberg and Al-Monitor (20 Aug, China MFA); Bloomberg and CNBC (20 Aug, Musalem); Reuters (20 Aug, oil); Bloomberg (18 Aug, diesel record); Al Jazeera (20 Aug, Kpler route split); Axios (19 Aug, convoy corridor); gasprices.aaa.com, read directly	The economic-war statements on both sides and China's response; Fed commentary; the named oil attributions; retail fuel; the route split and its provider caveat; throughput claims. Every anonymous-source claim is labelled as such where it is used.
Tier 1 provider · commercial data	Kpler (blog 19 Aug, and via Al Jazeera 20 Aug); Windward (19 Aug transit, jamming and blockade-breaker panels); Lloyd's List Intelligence (19 Aug Hormuz brief and TD3C); Marsh via S&P Global (22 Jul)	Transit counts with their own denominators, the dark/unknown route share, crude-on-water and Iranian loadings, the Chinese carrier withdrawal, Kharg activity, tanker earnings and war-risk premia. Kpler's own published revision factor of 1.5–2.0x on the most recent week is now the sourced basis for this monitor's rule against computing a day-on-day off a same-day print.
Tier 2 · secondary and trade	GlobalSecurity daily update (20 Aug); Washington Examiner citing CENTCOM (20 Aug); Tipswatch (20 Aug); CME FedWatch via aggregators; IMF PortWatch; Maritime Executive and INTERCARGO; straits.live	The 21st-night kinetic pause count, the George Washington arrival, TIPS auction and settlement colour, and September Fed pricing. Every figure in this row is labelled Tier 2 at first use and here. The 21-night kinetic-pause count and the George Washington arrival are each restated later without the label and should be read as Tier 2 throughout. The ~68% September hold reading is from an aggregator and not a CME print. straits.live's war-risk figure is its own model, not a broker quote, and is not carried.
Tier 3 · state media	SABA (18 Aug, Jazan claim); Mehr and Fars/WANA by reference only	Nothing in this edition is scored off a Tier 3 source. The Houthis claim to have struck Jazan on 18 August is in its fourth day without Saudi, Aramco or Tier 1 corroboration and is carried as a claim only. Iranian claims to have detained the tanker AMARA and turned back a Chinese tanker are Tier 3 in origin; the underlying vessel movements are independently observed by Windward and Bloomberg and only the observations are used.
Rejected, withdrawn or unresolved this edition	Listed for audit	B's lapse read as persisting, the Treasury legs' convergence read as a trend, and the dollar's three-month low read as a trend — all three TREND readings withdrawn by name after the 20 August close; the 19 August facts themselves stand (\$9.20, \$9.31). An ADNOC-vessel attack dated Friday 21 August — the source page is dated 14 August; rejected. A '17.4 mn bbl' crude build attributed to ING — a garble of the 17.4 mn b/d refinery-input line; the actual build was 4.4 mn bbl; not used. The derived ~\$101.2 diesel crack for 19 August — not repeated as an observation; no crack has been published for three sessions. A 0.5 bp 20-year tail — cannot be confirmed from any Treasury source and is not asserted. UKMTO 086's date of 17 August — corrected to 18 August. The '91 vessels redirected' CENTCOM caption — still irreconcilable with its own 65; still not used. Lloyd's List weekly figures of 84 and 78 — a secondary summary conflicts with the provider's own 73 and 91; the provider's numbers are used. The DOE weekly retail values of \$4.049 and \$5.454 — could not be re-verified outside the terminal for a second edition and are carried with that flag. Also unresolved: incidents 115-26 and 116-26 as one fatal attack or two (the numbering says two). Standing items carried forward but NOT relied on in this edition's body: the Sinokor VLCC named as Singapore Prosperity or Bulgaria Prosperity; the Iranian claim to have detained the tanker AMARA; the pre-2026 diesel-crack record (\$89 or \$86.82); the distillate-stocks comparison (1996 or 1998); the Baltic week-34 averages, not obtained.

A8 · On-demand update protocol

#	Step	Detail
1	Refresh and integrity-check the extract	Scan the header row rather than hardcoding columns; auto-detect the Brent and WTI front month. Run the row-level stale check (§9.8) by diffing the prior row against the figures published for it, and the field-level check (§9.35) for values identical to four decimals. Add a basis check: compare the continuation against the active contract for every energy benchmark, because a roll breaks the series silently (§9.36). This edition: the row check clears, the field check FIRES on the 30-year, and the basis check caught a WTI roll and a CLA restatement.
2	Compute deltas and test every trigger explicitly	d/d against the last confirmed close, w/w against five sheet-rows back, and vs the 27 Feb anchor re-verified field by field. Test all four market channels and Stage-4 A, B and C on the confirmed close only, and record the distance in basis points or dollars so the direction of travel is visible edition to edition. Run min, max and last-prior-occurrence queries on the full series before writing any superlative drawn from the EXTRACT (§9.32); superlatives on off-extract series — the Philadelphia Fed, the SPR, the auction records — are attributed to the publisher that made them. Every extract superlative here was checked that way and two were narrowed before printing.
3	Verify the news on both tracks and re-verify what was inherited	Military and diplomatic on one track, shipping, energy and macro on the other. Re-run negative claims every edition they are repeated (§9.23) — absence-of-evidence decays faster than positive facts, and this edition proves it twice: UKMTO published after two frozen editions, and Oman published after twelve days. State the exact query alongside the answer. Where several trackers disagree, publish every number with its denominator and take no average (§9.24).
4	Reconcile the previous snapshot and withdraw conclusions by name	The Singapore-morning cut regularly misses the US session, in either direction and sometimes in both at once. This edition's cut understated every reconciled field bar one, all the same way, so three conclusions built on it are withdrawn by name rather than quietly restated (§9.20, §9.31). Test every field for carry-status before it enters a reconciliation, and publish the exclusions (§9.37); none were needed this time.
5	Score on confirmed closes, with hysteresis, and explain the composition	Never move a market channel on an intraday print; never whipsaw on a single session; never move a downgrade rule to match the level that fired the upgrade. When the scale is saturated, say so — the total registers neither deterioration nor improvement (§9.7, §9.27), so the analysis has to carry what the number cannot. This edition: the incident count rose by three, the kinetic record went empty, the US declared an objective of regime collapse, and the score is flat at 27 for an eleventh time.

A9 · Methodology

Data. All market series come from a single Bloomberg extract refreshed by the user each working day. The sheet is parsed by scanning its header row rather than by column position, because tickers are relabelled and columns inserted between uploads. **The latest row is an intraday snapshot taken on the Singapore morning; the row before it is the last confirmed close, and every score test in this document runs on the confirmed close.** History is restated by the vendor from time to time — this edition the WTI active-contract column, across 3–20 August — so absolute levels are not comparable with pre-restatement editions while directional analysis is continuous. **Three integrity checks now run every edition.** The row-level check (§9.8) diffs the prior row against the figures published for it. The field-level check (§9.35) treats any field printing identical to four decimals against the previous session as UNRESOLVED and asserts no day-on-day change for it, **regardless of whether the row around it is live**; it fires on the 30-year here, the second time it has caught that series and the reason the rule exists. **The third is new in practice: a basis check of each continuation series against its active contract, because a roll breaks a continuation silently and a trigger measured across one is not comparable either side of it (§9.36).** It caught a WTI roll that would otherwise have printed as a \$2.46 fall. **Missing prints are labelled, never carried forward as fresh, and re-checked next edition for backfill.** **Scoring.** Six channels, each 0 to 5, summed to 0–30. Two channels are event-driven and four are market-driven. **Market channels move only on confirmed closes, never on an intraday print,** and event channels move only on events, not announcements: a declared posture, a stated objective, an unissued declaration or a trailed sanctions package is not an event (§9.11). **Hysteresis is asymmetric by design.** An upgrade fires on a sustained break of a stated level; the corresponding downgrade requires a sustained reversal past a wider one. **This edition is the strongest vindication of that property the document has produced:** the previous session's 9 bp long-end rally, its lapsed Stage-4 threshold and its three-month dollar low were all undone or materially given back within one close — 62% of the rally, the lapse entirely, the dollar low as a trend — and no score moved on any of them, because none met a documented rule. **The cost is also visible** — the US-inflation channel fired on a 2.30% break in the 5y5y forward and its documented downgrade sits at the 2.142% pre-war anchor, 20.12 bp below Thursday's close. **The gap is reported rather than closed, and the rule is not moved to match the tape (§9.16, §9.26).** **The saturation problem.** Maritime denial and escalation risk have both been at 5 since early July. **Further deterioration in either cannot raise the total, so a flat score is an artifact of the scale (§9.7);** the same failure runs in reverse when everything improves (§9.27). **This edition is a fourth variant: the two capped channels moved in OPPOSITE directions** — three new confirmed incidents against an empty kinetic record and a 23-day combat silence — **and the total could register neither, nor a Treasury Secretary saying on television that the intent is to collapse the Iranian government.** **Sourcing.** Every factual claim carries an attribution and a tier. State media is labelled Tier 3 and is never used for anything market-moving without Tier 1 corroboration. **Negative claims are re-verified at source every edition they are repeated, with the exact query stated (§9.23).** **That paid twice this week: UKMTO published Update 087 after two frozen editions and Oman published on Hormuz after twelve days, and carrying either negative forward would have missed both.** **Where trackers disagree, every number is published with its own denominator and no average is taken (§9.24)** — a rule that now extends to auction allotments, where 62.93% and 62.17% are the same award measured against competitive accepted and against total award. **Extract superlatives are checked against the full series before they are written (§9.32),** and inherited claims are re-verified on the same schedule as new ones (§9.13). **Where the previous edition built a conclusion on a snapshot that the close then contradicted, the conclusion is withdrawn by name (§9.20, §9.31);** three are withdrawn as trends here. **And where a threshold's written test depends on a figure that its primary source structurally does not publish — as Stage-4 Threshold A now does, since Treasury never releases a when-issued level — the test is untestable rather than merely unverified,**

and \$9.21 and \$9.33 require it to be replaced rather than left pending. That is recorded here as an open item.

A10 · Pre-war anchor and live trigger levels

The 27 Feb 2026 close, re-verified field by field every edition and unchanged to date. Trigger states are on the 20 Aug close, the last confirmed one.

Series	Pre-war close (27 Feb 2026)	Live trigger	State on the 20 Aug close
Brent (CO2)	\$72.48	Oil to 3 on sustained closes above \$95; to 1 on a mediated pause with a close at or below \$72.48	\$91.97 — \$3.03 below the upgrade on the scored series, \$1.22 on the active close, and \$19.49 above the downgrade anchor. Fourth consecutive edition of narrowing
WTI (CL2)	\$67.02	unscored	\$86.83 (+29.6%). The continuation rolled on the 21 Aug row and the CLA column was restated across 3–20 August — see A1.
2Y · 5Y · 10Y · 30Y	3.3749% · 3.5017% · 3.9375% · 4.6106%	Treasury to 4 on a 30-year close under 5.00% together with MOVE under 75, sustained	4.1875 · 4.3904 · 4.7041 · 5.2476 . The 30-year leg fails by 24.76 bp, WIDENED from 19.11 ; the volatility leg is satisfied for a third close
2s10s	+55.64 bp	unscored	51.235 bp, 4.41 bp flatter than pre-war
5y5y forward	2.142%	US inflation to 4 on sustained closes at or below 2.142%	2.3432% — 20.12 bp above the anchor, WIDENED from 16.86 . A fifth consecutive close above the 2.30% level whose break fired the upgrade
10Y breakeven	2.2569%	corroboration only	2.3525% — the highest since 8 June and 9.56 bp above the anchor , from 0.21 bp on 13 August
MOVE	73.38	Stage-4 C at 130; the volatility leg of the Treasury downgrade at 75	73.18 — below 75 for a third consecutive close, but only 0.20 below the anchor. 56.82 points below C
VIX	19.86	unscored	16.01, the highest close since 4 August
DXY	97.608	unscored	98.895 — still 1.3% ABOVE pre-war after six months of war
Gasoline · AAA all-grades (AUTMUSAG)	\$3.52	Political stress to 4 on three consecutive closes at or below \$4.60 with no intervening print above \$4.70	\$4.82 (19 Aug) — 22 cents away, WIDENED from 19 , and 7 cents above the \$4.75 trigger that fired the upgrade
Henry Hub	\$3.063	unscored — the control variable	\$2.733, 10.8% BELOW pre-war
TTF	€31.227	unscored	€65.295 — a new war-record close, +109.1%
Asia LNG (JGLA)	¥1,669	unscored	¥3,543 (+112.3%), the highest close since 24 July
Stage-4 A	n/a	An auction clearing with a tail above its when-issued level	NOT ARMED — and untestable as written: Treasury publishes no when-issued level, so the tail cannot be confirmed from any Treasury source. Recorded as an open item
Stage-4 B	n/a	30Y above 5.20% with 10Y above 4.65%, both on confirmed closes	RE-ARMED on the 20 Aug close after exactly one session out — the fifth arming and the ninth state. Clears by 4.76 and 5.41 bp
Stage-4 C	n/a	MOVE above 130 on confirmed closes	Not armed. 73.18, 56.82 points below. War high 115.02 (26 Mar); series low 65.39 (18 Jun)